

On the Use of This Work

Work: All texts, analyses, and accompanying materials published under the name **An Unnamed Resistor License: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0** Published: May 8, 2026

Note on translation: This is a reference translation. The Japanese version is the authoritative text. In the event of any difference in interpretation, the Japanese version prevails.

Introduction

This document explains, in plain terms, how this work may be used and how it should not be used.

This work is not an authority that delivers answers. It is **material** intended to provoke the reader's own thinking. The author has no wish to position himself as a "judge of ideas" or "provider of justice." Indeed, that readers arrive at conclusions different from the author's is regarded as among the highest successes of this work.

For this reason, the conditions for use have been kept as simple as possible. Conditions that demand careful study before use are, by that very fact, neither fair nor transparent. This document defers most matters to the standard Creative Commons license (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0), and supplements only what that license cannot, on its own, address.

Structure of This Document

This document contains **three layers, each of a fundamentally different nature**. They should not be confused.

Layer	Section	Nature
Legal conditions of use	§ 1- § 4	Based on CC BY-NC-SA and copyright law. If you observe these, you may use the work freely without contacting the author.
Channel for individual consultation	§ 1.5	The point of contact for uses that fall outside § 1- § 4.
Requests from the author	§ 5	Has no legal force. Things the author would like to ask of users, even those acting in compliance with CC.

1. License: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Prelude: Why This License

This work seeks to satisfy four aims at once:

- **It should spread as discussion** (and so it must be open)
- **The context of who wrote it should not disappear** (and so attribution is required)
- **The unfreedom of those involved should not become a resource for outsiders to monetize** (and so commercial use is treated separately)
- **Derivative works should not be enclosed and locked away** (and so the same conditions are inherited by derivatives)

CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 implements all four in a form recognizable internationally. Rather than crafting a custom license, riding on a standard license intelligible worldwide produces greater transparency for both users and the author.

1.1 What the License Says

This work may be freely used under three conditions:

- **BY (Attribution)** – Indicate the author's name (An Unnamed Resistor) and information about the original work (title, URL, etc.)
- **NC (NonCommercial)** – Do not use the work for commercial purposes
- **SA (ShareAlike)** – When making derivatives such as translations, summaries, or adaptations, publish them under the same CC BY-NC-SA license

Official license text: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/>

1.2 The Boundary of "Non-Commercial" (Supplement)

CC's own definition of non-commercial use ("not primarily intended for or directed toward commercial advantage or monetary compensation") is somewhat abstract. To make matters more concrete for this work, the following clarifies what counts as **commercial use**.

Treated as commercial (requires individual consultation under §1.5)

- Use in monetized videos and live streams (Twitch, niconico, etc. For YouTube, see §1.3)
- Articles or videos containing affiliate links
- Compensation features active during streams or live videos: Super Chat, Super Thanks, viewer tips, and the like
- Membership-only or subscription-only streams or articles
- Paid articles, subscription-limited articles, content behind paywalls

- Commercial publications, paid lectures, corporate training, internal company materials
- Incorporation into products or services
- Monetization via NFTs, tokenization, or blockchain integration
- Resale to other services as data

Typically treated as non-commercial

- Personal study notes, research notes
- Personal blogs or social media without advertising
- Tip / support features that come as standard in web articles, set up passively (provided no inducement or solicitation is made in connection with use of this work)
- Academic research and papers (peer-reviewed or not)
- Free educational materials at educational institutions
- Policy review documents at public institutions

Regarding ads automatically inserted by the platform

If the platform automatically inserts ads that the user cannot disable (some free blog services, etc.), the use is treated as commercial in principle. In exceptional cases where permission is needed, please consult under § 1.5.

1.3 Use on YouTube and Other Video Platforms

Prelude

Video platforms such as YouTube layer monetization features at multiple levels – per video, per stream, and channel-wide. Because users may unintentionally cross the NC line, this section states the principle explicitly.

Principle

Use is permitted in principle only when (a) ad monetization is not enabled on the specific video or live stream, and (b) no affiliate links or other paths that could lead to revenue are placed in the description, comments, or similar fields.

Forms of use outside this permission

The following require individual consultation under § 1.5:

- Live streams with Super Chat, Super Thanks, or tip features active
- Members-only videos or content
- Paid premieres or paid ticketed streams
- Sponsored or branded-content (corporate tie-up) videos

- Any other form of use involving **consideration** – that is, something exchanged for value

1.4 What Happens When Use Falls Outside CC

Prelude

This section is somewhat formal in tone, but the aim is to explain the logic of what happens. The intent is not to threaten, but to allow users to understand in advance the situation that arises.

Explanation

CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 has a built-in mechanism: the license does not apply to use that fails to meet its conditions (see Section 6 of the license).

In other words, if any of the conditions – NC (non-commercial), BY (attribution), or SA (share-alike) – is broken:

- The CC-based permission **terminates automatically**
- From that point on, the only criterion for whether the use is lawful is whether it satisfies the **quotation requirements under copyright law** (§ 2)
- Any portion that fails the quotation requirements is treated as **ordinary copyright infringement**, with or without CC

This is not a special penalty. It is simply that, the moment CC ceases to be observed, things return to the world without CC.

1.5 Channel for Individual Consultation

For uses that CC does not permit (commercial use and other special cases), please consult by email.

Contact: an_unnamed_resistor@structuralunderstanding.com

The criteria for review are not set out in detail in advance. Each case is considered individually based on purpose, medium, scope, and context. A response may take time (a few weeks as a rough guide).

2. About Quotation

Prelude

Apart from CC BY-NC-SA, copyright law in each jurisdiction includes a “quotation” right limitation. Quotation of this work is permitted, **even when the conditions of CC are not met**, to the extent that it satisfies the quotation requirements under copyright law (this is a mandatory limitation on the author’s exclusive rights).

This section makes concrete what is required for a “quotation” to be valid.

2.1 Requirements for Quotation

Under Article 32 of the Japanese Copyright Act, use that satisfies all of the following requires no permission:

- **Indication of source:** information about this work (author name, title, URL, etc.) is shown
- **Clarity of the principal-subordinate relationship:** the quoted portion is subordinate to the user's own work
- **Clear distinction:** the quoted portion is clearly marked off (quotation marks, block quotations, etc.)
- **Necessary minimum:** limited to the minimum necessary for the purpose of the quotation

Where a user invokes the quotation provisions of another country's law (such as fair use in the United States), the burden of establishing those requirements rests on the user.

2.2 The Distinction Between "Quotation" and "Adaptation"

The following uses do not constitute quotation. They may fall under "adaptation" (Article 2, paragraph 1, item 11 of the Japanese Copyright Act) or "reproduction":

- Summary or abstract (a shortened form of the main content)
- Paraphrase (restating the same content in different expressions)
- Recomposition or rearrangement (regrouping multiple quoted portions, or changing the structure)
- Translation (rendering into a different language)
- Annotation or commentary (analyzing the original and adding the user's own interpretation)
- Conversion into figures or visualizations (converting text content into graphs, tables, or diagrams)

To do any of these, please proceed under CC BY-NC-SA, or, for uses beyond CC, seek permission through the individual consultation channel in §1.5.

2.3 Descriptive Summary (No Permission Required)

A "descriptive summary" that satisfies all of the following conditions is treated not as a copyright matter but as a factual reference that does not reconstruct the article's content – neither quotation nor adaptation:

- It contains no quotation of the original expression (including extraction or paraphrase of phrases)
- It does not reconstruct, summarize, interpret, or edit the content

- It describes the type, topic, and analytical perspective of the article in the user's own style
- The summary itself is not used as grounds for condemning, attacking, or evaluating a third party

Example of a descriptive summary: "This article analyzes the contractual structure of the VTuber industry from a sociological perspective." This does not reconstruct the article's content; it merely characterizes the document. Such a description is acceptable.

Prohibited uses: Summarizing the article's argument or conclusions, listing its points or claims, extracting key phrases, reproducing its structure, similar phrasing or paraphrasing or vocabulary substitution, evaluative or comparative description, using a "descriptive summary" as cover for criticism, evaluation, or political claim, or as grounds for attack or condemnation of others. These exceed the scope of descriptive summary and are treated as unauthorized use.

Source attribution: A descriptive summary does not require source attribution; if a link is included voluntarily, it should be done in a way that does not damage the accuracy of the article.

Position under copyright law: A descriptive summary does not constitute reproduction, adaptation, or summary under copyright law. It is treated as a "factual introductory act" that does not give rise to copyrightability. However, if the summary trespasses into the original expression, ordinary quotation limits and the provisions of this document apply.

3. Free Use of Ideas, Facts, and Thoughts

Prelude

Copyright law protects "the form of expression," not "the content of thought" itself. This is often misunderstood, so it is set out explicitly. Users may freely make use of the ideas, facts, and thoughts contained in this work, with no copyright-based restriction.

3.1 What May Be Used Freely

- **Ideas and concepts:** ideas, research directions, analytical perspectives contained in this work
- **Facts and data:** statistics, dates, figures, and events cited and analyzed
- **Language and concepts:** general language and theoretical frameworks

such as “structural understanding” or “thinking subjectivity”

- **Thoughts and claims:** the thoughts, values, and philosophical positions developed in this work

3.2 These Uses Are Welcomed

- Writing your own analysis based on the ideas in this work
- Independently analyzing the facts or data quoted in this work
- Critically examining the thoughts in this work from a different perspective
- Reaching your own conclusions, using the perspectives shown here as a reference

It is entirely fine – indeed welcomed – to disagree with the author’s conclusions, to criticize them, to refute them. That readers reach independent judgment through critical examination is, in the author’s view, the highest success of this work.

3.3 What Falls Within Copyright (CC or Individual Permission Required)

- Reproducing the work’s expressive style as-is
- Modifying the text and redistributing it
- Imitating the structure of the work

4. The Author’s Own Practice

Prelude

This section sets out how the author treats the works of others. It is a statement of “this is how I do it,” more than a demand on the user. The same standard is, by implication, expected to be reciprocated.

4.1 Public-Institution Materials

Materials made public by public institutions (UNESCO, the EU, UN agencies, governments, etc.) are used in accordance with the institution’s usage policy and customary practice.

4.2 Academic Works

For academic publications, theses, and research reports, the customary practices of the academic community (citations to peer-reviewed papers, proper indication of secondary citation, etc.) are strictly followed.

4.3 Corporate and Individual Works

The quotation requirements of Article 32 of the Japanese Copyright Act are strictly observed:

- Indication of source (author name, title, URL, date of publication,

etc.)

- Clarity of the principal-subordinate relationship (quoted portion is subordinate)
- Clear distinction of the quoted portion (quotation marks, block quotations, etc.)
- Limited to the necessary minimum
- Use without modification of the work

4.4 Response to Violations of Policy

If materials have been used in a manner contrary to the above policy, prompt correction, deletion, or other appropriate response will be made upon notice.

5. Requests from the Author

The following are **requests from the author, with no legal force**. There are things the author wishes to share even with those who use this work in compliance with CC BY-NC-SA.

This work addresses the experience of those whose voice is constrained by structural asymmetries of power and information. Among uses that the law permits, there are nevertheless some that the author would like to identify as “not what was intended.” Specifically:

- Using this work as “absolute truth” or “grounds for justice” to attack or condemn third parties
- Treating the urgent unfreedom of those involved as “material easy to consume as content”
- Bringing forth the author as an “authority” who guarantees the rightness of conclusions

These run counter to the author’s intent.

These are requests at the level of trust between reader and author, and depend on mutual good faith. They are not enforceable. If they are not honored, there is little the author can do beyond stating his view again. Even so, it is worth setting them out openly. To indicate what is important to the author is itself material for the reader’s reflection on how this work might be used.

6. Other Matters

6.1 Personal Information

The author does not operate any system to collect personal information in connection with the use of this work (no registration form, pledge, license-number system, etc.). CC BY-NC-SA can be used without prior application; users are not required to provide their names or other identifying information.

Only when contacting the author through the individual consultation under §1.5 will the author come into possession of the user's email address or other contact details. Such information is used solely for the purpose of that consultation, and is never used commercially or provided to third parties.

6.2 Governing Law and Jurisdiction

Prelude

Precisely because this work circulates internationally, it is necessary to decide in advance, in the event of a dispute, which jurisdiction's law applies and which court will hear the matter.

What is concretely envisaged includes situations such as: a CC license violation has been discovered but the user does not respond to a request to correct or remove the use; or commercial use has occurred without going through the individual consultation under §1.5, and good-faith negotiations toward a remedy fail to reach agreement – situations in which legal recourse must, ultimately, be considered. Without this provision, every dispute would begin from arguing "where to litigate," which serves no one.

This is not put in place to welcome dispute, but to minimize the cost of handling a dispute if and when one arises.

Provisions

- **Governing law:** Japanese law
- **Court of exclusive jurisdiction at first instance:** Tokyo District Court

The authoritative version of this document is in Japanese. Other-language versions are reference translations. In the event of any difference in interpretation, the Japanese version prevails.

6.3 Contact

an_unnamed_resistor@structuralunderstanding.com

The author's environment may automatically discard email from senders deemed unreliable or from unverified domains. The author bears no

responsibility for non-delivery in such cases. Maintaining a deliverable sending environment is the user's responsibility.

Revision History

Date	Content
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May 8, 2026	First edition published
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